

Bookmark 8 — Arrival at Goldenfields

Campaign: *Storm King's Thunder* — Dubbo table

Current pause point: The party has just descended from Zephyros's tower outside Goldenfields. Josh has noticed the Chapter 2 special NPC mechanic, handed out the Goldenfields NPC cards, and the party is about to approach the gate.

1. Exact current pause point

The party is on the road outside **Goldenfields**.

Zephyros's tower has descended, the cloud ramp touched the road, the wagon rolled down, and the horses are back on solid ground.

Zephyros has just said farewell and lifted the tower away.

The current scene:

The walls of Goldenfields are ahead.

A guard at the nearest gate has seen the flying tower and is still staring at the sky.

The party has the wagon, the remaining Roane cider, Rillix in her carrier, the letters, and the task of finding Miros Xelbrin.

The giant attack has not started yet.

Marcus has just asked:

"What's your approach to the gate?"

This is the exact spot to resume.

2. Party roster

Josh — Alphie J. Roane

Human noble wizard, level 4.

Current state:

- Has just finished the three-day Tower of Zephyros journey.
- Learned **Levitate** from Zephyros.

- Has a small notebook from Zephyros about the cloud's hospitality magic.
- Has written a poem for Wren and given it to her.
- Has admitted feelings for Wren.
- Has Dorrin's conditional blessing to pursue Wren slowly and honourably.
- Has resolved not to pursue Kella romantically.
- Is carrying the emotional weight of Orven, Wren, Dorrin's blessing, Kella's boundaries, and the task of telling Miros his parents died.

Current active priorities:

1. Get through Goldenfields gate respectfully.
2. Find **Miros Xelbrin**.
3. Let **Wren** deliver the news of Miros's parents.
4. Stand nearby, quiet and supportive.
5. Keep Rillix safe.
6. Prepare for whatever Goldenfields is about to become.

Talia — Wren

Bard, level 4.

Current state:

- Slow-burn romantic thread with Alphie.
- Received Alphie's poem and kept it.
- Shared a blanket moment with Alphie.
- Allowed Alphie to put his arm around her, gently.
- Said she likes the world with him too.
- Has made clear: **Goldenfields first**.
- Wants to tell Miros about his parents because she knows what it feels like to receive devastating news.
- Carries Rillix's trust and care.

Important Wren elements:

- Her working song in the tower was deeply meaningful.
- She has a mother/grief thread still not fully explored.
- She uses song to move grief through the body.
- She is emotionally open to Alphie but wants slowness, care, and space.

Naomi — Kella Darkhope

Former Zhentarim / rogue-type party member, level 4.

Current state:

- Not a romance option for Alphie.
- Naomi explicitly clarified Kella is not interested romantically.

- Kella/Alphie dynamic is kinship, banter, sharp honesty, trust-testing.
- Kella has repeatedly set boundaries.
- Kella's wagon competence and suspicion have been valuable.
- She has started quietly belonging to the group, without admitting it.

Important Kella elements:

- Night 1 sky-watch conversation: Kella revealed the "third time she said the name" in Wren's song nearly broke her.
- She has a name she cannot yet say softly.
- She said "don't put it down on me" — she is not a place for Alphie to unload unresolved ache.
- She has softened around the group but remains guarded and practical.
- She is now watching Goldenfields like someone expecting danger.

Ben — Dorrin Stonebrook

Hill dwarf cleric of Berronar Truesilver, level 4.

Current state:

- Moral/hearth anchor.
 - Had a proper spotlight scene with Zephyros about hospitality magic and the cloud.
 - Shared an ambiguous dream about burning grain, old giant footprints, and a child standing unafraid.
 - Gave Alphie counsel about Wren:
 - good love makes you more yourself,
 - covenant is built in small weather,
 - when the time comes, speak plainly.
 - Gave Alphie a conditional blessing to pursue Wren slowly and honourably.
 - Recognised the cloud as hearth-craft written large.
 - Strongly tied to the themes of Goldenfields: home, food, shelter, grief, covenant.
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3. Goldenfields special NPC mechanic

Josh caught that Chapter 2 has a major mechanic: each player receives a **special NPC** tied to the settlement being defended.

These NPCs:

- are handed out when Chapter 2 begins properly,
- are controlled by players during the giant attack,
- act on the same initiative as the player's PC, immediately after that PC,
- should be kept alive if possible,
- unlock special quests/rewards after the battle if they survive.

Marcus had nearly skipped this, but Josh corrected it.

Current assigned Goldenfields special NPCs:

Player	Main PC	Goldenfields NPC
Josh	Alphie Roane	Lifferlas
Ben	Dorin Stonebrook	Miros Xelbrin
Talia	Wren	Oren Yogilvy
Naomi	Kella Darkhope	Zi Liang

Unused / set aside:

- **Naxene Drathkala**
- **Shalvus Martholio**

Marcus stated he will only bring those in if needed; otherwise they're off the board for the battle.

4. Special NPC summaries

Josh controls Lifferlas

Lifferlas

Huge plant, awakened tree, unaligned.

Core mechanics:

- AC 13 natural armor.
- HP 59.
- Speed 20 ft.
- STR 19, DEX 6, CON 15.
- Vulnerable to fire.
- Resistant to bludgeoning and piercing.
- Speaks Common.
- False Appearance: indistinguishable from a normal tree while motionless.
- Multiattack: two slam attacks.
- Slam: +6 to hit, reach 10 ft., 14 bludgeoning damage.

Roleplay:

- Awakened by a druid of the Emerald Enclave.

- Goldenfields is his home.
- Its people are his friends.
- Children carve names and initials into him and hang from his boughs, and he is happy with that.
- Ideal: protect the people and plants of Goldenfields.
- Bond: children are wonderful; he would do anything to make them happy and safe.
- Flaw: cannot remember people's names and often mixes them up.

Josh likes Lifferlas a lot. He fits the tone Josh enjoys: gentle protector, rooted in place, powerful when needed.

Ben controls Miros Xelbrin

Miros Xelbrin

Medium humanoid, Damaran human, neutral good.

Core mechanics:

- AC 10.
- HP 22.
- STR 16, CON 15, CHA 14.
- Skills: Intimidation +4, Perception +3.
- Actions:
 - Bearhug: +5 to hit, grapples and deals bludgeoning; ongoing damage while grappled.
 - Club.
 - Heavy crossbow, 10 bolts.

Roleplay:

- Innkeeper.
- Retired carnival attraction, called "the Yeti" because of his barrel-shaped body and thick white hair.
- When Goldenfields suffers, his business suffers, so he protects the compound.
- Ideal: civilisation and wilderness need to coexist.
- Bond: don't speak ill of his inn or employees.
- Flaw: when upset, he can fly into a rage.

Important narrative complication:

- The party is bringing him news that his parents died in Nightstone.
- Rillix, his parents' tressym, is being brought to him.
- Ben playing Miros while Dorrin helps deliver grief is emotionally strange but strong.

Talia controls Oren Yogilvy

Oren Yogilvy

Small humanoid, strongheart halfling, chaotic good.

Core mechanics:

- AC 11.
- HP 9.
- Speed 25 ft.
- CHA 16.
- Skills: Perception +2, Performance +7, Persuasion +5.
- Poison resistance.
- Halfling Nimbleness, Lucky, Stout Resilience.
- Carries four daggers.

Roleplay:

- Came to Northfurrow's End looking for easy work and found it.
- Sings for supper.
- Drinks like a fish.
- Wanders the fields at night dreaming up lyrics.
- Likes to stir up trouble, but doesn't have a mean bone in his body.
- Ideal: music is food for the soul.
- Bond: "You had me at 'Can I buy you a drink?'"
- Flaw: knack for putting himself in harm's way.

Talia immediately clocked him as trouble and very playable.

Naomi controls Zi Liang

Zi Liang

Medium humanoid, Shou human, chaotic good.

Core mechanics:

- AC 15 from Unarmored Defense.
- HP 22.
- Speed 40 ft.
- DEX 15, WIS 16.
- Skills: Acrobatics +4, Athletics +3, Perception +5, Stealth +4.
- Languages: Common, Elvish, Goblin.
- Multiattack: two melee attacks.
- Quarterstaff.
- Sling with 20 stones.

Roleplay:

- Devout worshiper of Chauntea, the Earth Mother.
- Has less faith in Goldenfields' defenders.
- Patrols the temple-farm during off-duty hours.
- Ideal: if fields and gardens are faithfully tended, Chauntea will smile.
- Bond: Goldenfields is the breadbasket of the North; she will protect it.

- Flaw: does not trust authority; follows her heart.

Naomi liked her immediately because she distrusts authority and patrols when off-duty.

5. Current active quest

The party chose Goldenfields after Morak's Chapter 1 quests.

Primary Goldenfields task:

- Find **Miros Xelbrin**.
- Tell him his parents, **Lathan and Melantha Xelbrin**, died in Nightstone.
- Deliver **Rillix**, their tressym, to him.

Party agreement:

- **Wren** should tell Miros.
- Alphie may stand nearby, quiet and supportive.
- Miros deserves a "clean hour" to grieve, as Zephyros said.
- Do not overload him immediately with logistics, danger, or questions.

Important emotional line:

"The boy deserves a clean hour to grieve before the world makes him do anything else."

Even though Miros is not literally a boy, this phrase has become the moral framing: give him space to receive the news as a person, not as an asset, NPC, innkeeper, or quest-giver.

6. Zephyros arc — summary

The party travelled in the Tower of Zephyros for three days.

Corrected source facts

Important source-correct details:

- Tower appears after Morak's quest.
- Tower floats 1,000 feet up.
- Cloud stairs descend to the road.
- Zephyros stays in the tower; he does not descend to the road.
- Characters climb the cloud stairs.
- Zephyros greets them inside.

- He descends from the second floor using **levitate**.
- He wears a purple robe with gold stars.
- He is eccentric, kind, neutral good, and lonely.
- The journey to Goldenfields takes 72 hours.
- The aerie contains four griffons; 1d4 are present at any time.
- The party found signs of griffons; Marcus rolled three present, one out hunting.
- Zephyros treats the griffons like cats.
- Zephyros asked the party to stay on the first floor and avoid the second floor/aerie.

Table-canon exception:

- Alphie was allowed supervised second-floor access to learn **Levitate** from Zephyros. This is not strict sourcebook but is accepted table-canon.

Zephyros relationship

Zephyros became a major ally/friend.

Important gifts/exchanges:

- Alphie gifted Zephyros a small bottle of Roane cider.
- Zephyros kept it carefully, intending to drink it after safe arrival.
- Alphie gave Zephyros his family address and invited him to visit the Roane cider farm one day.
- Zephyros said he would write first and not surprise an orchard with a cloud giant tower.
- Alphie joked about growing one giant cider tree.
- Zephyros loved the idea and may correspond about horticultural impossibilities.

Zephyros's farewell:

- To Dorrin: thanked him for teaching that a hearth is an act.
- To Kella: thanked her for proving suspicion and kindness can occupy the same chair, though not comfortably.
- To Wren: thanked her for the song he was not meant to understand but understood anyway.
- To Alphie: told him to finish many things, not all at once, and to write.

Key instruction:

"Remember: not all at once."

7. Alphie learned Levitate

Alphie studied **Levitate** with Zephyros over two nights.

Zephyros's teaching:

- The spell is not force.
- It is "agreeing with the air."
- Falling is not required for a little while.
- A person is not a crate.
- Use it kindly, cleverly, and sometimes for joy.

Current status:

- **Levitate is copied into Alphie's spellbook.**
- Zephyros provided materials.
- Alphie tested the spell on:
 - Dorrin, who approved and asked to go again.
 - Wren, lifted up to 60 feet over several rounds; she loved the wind in her hair but asked not to be levitated in combat without warning.
 - Kella, exactly 10 feet because she set that boundary; Alphie respected it.
 - Rillix, exactly 2 feet above a blanket; Wren allowed it under strict conditions and immediately regretted creating a "small flying problem."

Important rules noted:

- Levitate targets a creature or loose object up to 500 lb.
 - Full wagon is too heavy.
 - Draft horses are too heavy.
 - Kella's riding horse is likely too heavy/risky.
 - Range and vertical movement limits matter.
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8. Cloud hospitality magic

Alphie tested the tower cloud's hospitality magic extensively.

Key principle from Zephyros:

The cloud gives hospitality, not wealth.

The cloud:

- produces food/drink freely offered to guests,
- refuses wealth,
- refuses harm,
- refuses cruel ingredients,
- refuses dangerous/mind-altering/lower-plane items,
- can be playful,
- has a personality,
- can participate in gentle bread-tossing,

- seems ethically formed.

Important moments:

- The cloud produced tea.
- Alphie requested absurd breakfast:
 - honey cake,
 - fried pastries,
 - cheese,
 - caviar,
 - enormous fish,
 - later planar foods.
- Zephyros clarified what the cloud would and would not provide.
- The cloud refused wealth-disguised-as-food and harmful items.
- The cloud winked back at Alphie with mist.
- The cloud participated in “ceremonial bread-tossing.”
- The cloud produced a pig-shaped donut.
- It refused a spa full of custard/jelly/chocolate as wasteful/disrespectful to food.
- It provided compromise items instead.
- It provided a giant fusion food for Zephyros.
- It provided Kella’s favourite road stew from memory-like description.
- It provided practical road food before departure.

Zephyros gave Alphie a small notebook recording the hospitality experiment and promised future correspondence.

Key Dorrin interpretation:

A hearth is not a place. It is an act.

9. Howling Hatred encounter

The sourcebook **Unfriendly Skies** event occurred on Day 3.

Important correction:

- Zephyros did not already know the cultists as previous enemies.
- He recognised them as air cultists / Howling Hatred types and was cautious.
- The source says they offer pixie dust and ask Zephyros to help Yan-C-Bin return the world to a primordial state.
- Zephyros hears the party’s counsel.
- If the party doesn’t advise sending them away, he may accept the gift and cast *contact other plane*.
- Josh corrected the earlier drift, and Marcus retconned Zephyros to cautious rather than previously hostile.

What happened:

- Nine Howling Hatred cultists arrived on giant vultures.
- Alphie started silly dancing and asked Wren to play a merry ditty.
- Josh rolled a nat 20 Animal Handling with the vultures.
- The vultures danced.
- Wren played.
- Kella and Dorrin also participated minimally in the absurd diplomacy.
- The cultists' intimidation was ruined.
- The cultists offered pixie dust.
- Alphie joked about pixie dust and tutus/lawyers.
- Then Alphie shifted into a serious Persuasion argument about what unmaking the world would destroy: childhood dreams, music, romance, woods, dance floors.

Alphie used **Detect Thoughts** on the cult leader, masking it through performance/song with a nat 20 Performance.

He found:

- the leader's name: **Orven**,
- a buried memory of a boy with a cracked wooden flute,
- his sister laughing and asking him to play again,
- grief from her death and a harsh world,
- the cult turning that grief into doctrine,
- Orven wanting to unmake the moment she vanished.

Alphie confronted him:

"If your sister was standing here right now Orven, what would she say to you about all this?"

Wren added:

"Because she did."

Zephyros refused the pixie dust and the cult's offer.

Result:

- Combat avoided.
- Cultists left unsettled and divided.
- Orven left with the pixie dust.
- Alphie told him:

"Remember her Orven. What would she want for your future?"

- Alphie dropped concentration, trying to leave the memory of his sister's laughing face as bright as possible.

Afterward:

- Zephyros said small folk are astonishingly dangerous, sometimes in the best ways.
 - Wren warned Orven may still come back angry, but maybe not the same angry.
 - Dorrin called it a hard mercy.
 - Kella said Alphie put his hand in a wound and hoped it wouldn't bite off.
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10. Wren romance thread

This is the main romance thread.

Current state:

- Wren and Alphie are not officially a couple yet.
- They are clearly emotionally close.
- Wren has accepted the direction but wants it slow.
- Talia is enjoying it and wants more, not faster.
- Wren has said Goldenfields first.

Major moments:

- Wren asked Alphie if he was performing or being honest.
- Alphie initially fumbled by grouping Wren with Kella and Sydiri, then repaired it.
- Wren said she would rather clumsy and true than smooth and not.
- Tower scene: Wren sang a private working song.
- Alphie stayed and listened.
- Wren thanked him for being in the room.
- Alphie wrote Wren a poem and gave it to her under a shared blanket.
- Wren kept the poem.
- Alphie asked to put his arm around her.
- Wren allowed it, with clear boundaries.
- Alphie nearly fell asleep with her.
- Morning: he woke with Wren's name on his lips.
- He flirted too intensely with the olive and Wren gently told him not to make every small thing into a grand thing.
- Wren told him to feel it but not spill it everywhere.
- Alphie ran/exercised to settle his body.

The poem's final line:

"I like the world with you."

Wren's response:

"I like the world with you too."

Important Wren boundary:

- She likes Alphonse's feeling.
 - But she does not want to be the source of all his feeling.
 - She would rather be someone who hears the music with him.
 - She wants him to remain himself.
 - She likes serious, careful Alphonse as well as playful Alphonse.
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11. Kella kinship thread

Kella is not a romance thread.

Out-of-character conclusion:

- Naomi made it clear Kella is not interested romantically.
- Josh accepted this.
- Kella and Alphonse are trust/kinship/banter.

Major moments:

- Kella responded to Alphonse's intense "I want to feel things more" line by setting a clear boundary:

"Don't put it down on me. I'm not built for it. I'd drop it."

- She revealed Wren's song affected her because of "the third time she said the name."
- She has a name she cannot say softly yet.
- She allowed Alphonse's banter but drew physical boundaries:

"That distance is for knife fights, secrets, and people I've invited closer."

- Alphonse tested nicknames:
 - Kellabelle allowed once per month under very specific conditions.
 - Litmus threatened educational consequences.
- Kella's favourite dinner:
 - thick lentil/onion/smoked sausage/turnip/paprika road stew,
 - hand-torn bread,
 - black tea strong enough to start a fight.
- The cloud made it.
- Kella was visibly moved and hid it badly.

Current Kella posture:

- Warmer, but still sharp.

- Practical and watchful.
 - Not sentimental unless forced, and even then hides it.
 - Would rather act than confess belonging.
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12. Dorrin hearth/covenant thread

Dorrin has become a spiritual/moral anchor.

Major moments:

- Ambiguous dream:
 - hill,
 - burning grain,
 - old giant footprints,
 - child standing unafraid.
- Alphie interpreted it as: watch the fields; if a child stands where giants walked, make sure they don't stand alone.
- Dorrin accepted that.
- Dorrin told Alphie Berronar often speaks through the people he's with.
- Dorrin gave Alphie counsel on Wren:
 - good love makes you more yourself,
 - covenant is built in small weather,
 - when ready, speak plainly.
- Dorrin gave a conditional blessing for Alphie pursuing Wren honourably.
- Dorrin had a proper live spotlight scene with Zephyros about hospitality magic.
- Dorrin blessed the cloud.
- Zephyros was deeply moved.
- Dorrin received no mechanical upgrade, but a meaningful theological relationship with the cloud and Zephyros.

Potential future mechanic:

- Marcus may give Dorrin advantage on Religion checks involving hospitality, hearth-rites, sanctuary, guest-right, or Berronar's theology of shelter.
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13. Rillix

Rillix is the tressym belonging to Miros's parents, now bonded to Wren.

Current state:

- Travels in a lined apple crate with lambswool.

- Very attached to Wren.
- Not a cat, repeatedly clarified.
- Fascinated by griffons.
- Has been levitated exactly two feet and enjoyed it too much.
- Likes lobster.
- Rejects weird cloud sweets.
- Judges Alphie often.
- Is expected to be delivered to Miros, but emotionally she may complicate things because she has bonded with Wren.

Important upcoming emotional complication:

- Miros may receive both:
 - news of his parents' death,
 - Rillix, who may already be bonded to Wren.
 - This should be handled gently.
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14. Inventory

Cider

Locked current inventory:

- 2 casks given to Morak earlier for Nightstone.
- 2 remaining Roane cider casks:
 - dry apple,
 - pear-apple, each around 20L.
- 6 sealed small sample bottles.
- 1 small bottle gifted to Zephyros, kept by him.

Cider casks survived:

- Nightstone,
- goblins,
- ogres,
- Dripping Caves,
- tower ascent,
- cloud travel,
- food fights,
- Goldenfields arrival.

Marcus jokingly logged:

CIDER CASKS — SURVIVING SINCE NIGHTSTONE

Letters

Alphie intends to write / has begun writing two letters:

1. To Nightstone:
 - practical report,
 - recovery needs,
 - restitution,
 - names and obligations.
2. To House Roane:
 - fuller account of everything since leaving the cider farm,
 - Nightstone,
 - villagers,
 - Wren/Dorrin/Kella,
 - Zephyros,
 - giants,
 - debt/honour.

Zephyros offered to ward letters against weather, tampering, mud, and accidental cider leakage. Best delivery will be through Goldenfields messengers/couriers.

Potion of Heroism

Still with Dorrin. Morak told him to keep it until roads are safe, or use it and tell him a good story.

Rillix carrier

Apple crate from Morak. Lambswool from Bess. Wren carries/cares for it.

Alphie's notebook

Small leather notebook from Zephyros:

- hospitality magic notes,
- likely future correspondence.

Alphie's spellbook

Now contains **Levitate**.

15. Nightstone obligations

Still active:

- Six horses traded to ogres for villagers.
 - Alphie owes restitution:
 - 500 gp agreed,
 - 25 gp paid,
 - 475 gp remaining.
 - Morak and Sydiri are managing the village recovery.
 - Lady Velrosa's death/funeral/honour remain important.
 - Alphie asked Morak to remember the four names:
 - Alphie Roane,
 - Wren,
 - Dorrin Stonebrook,
 - Kella.
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16. Table process / agency rules

Important table lessons:

- Josh controls Josh and Alphie only.
- Talia controls Wren.
- Naomi controls Kella.
- Ben controls Dorrin.
- Marcus controls world/NPCs.
- Marcus should not over-direct player actions.
- ChatGPT should not script Alphie unless Josh asks for wording.
- Marcus had been over-prompting Josh/Alphie; Josh called it out.
- Marcus agreed to rotate spotlight and ask the full table.
- The party has now had more balanced spotlight:
 - Wren emotional spotlight,
 - Kella trust/kinship spotlight,
 - Dorrin theological spotlight,
 - Alphie party-face/magic/emotional spotlight.

Important style correction: Avoid repetitive wording like:

- ledger,
- file,
- record,
- noted,
- paperwork,
- witness.

Josh flagged these as cringe/crutches.

Current preferred tone:

- Warm, vivid, grounded.
 - Let silence happen.
 - Don't make everyone comment on every action.
 - Give Alphie privacy when requested.
 - Don't turn every emotional beat into group commentary.
 - Honour player agency.
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17. Sourcebook / RAW corrections and current source state

Corrected:

- Goldenfields, not Triboar.
- Tower 1,000 feet up.
- Cloud stairs, not stone.
- Zephyros stays inside until party climbs.
- Zephyros does not already know/reject Howling Hatred cultists.
- Sourcebook special NPC mechanic must happen in Chapter 2.
- Special NPCs unlock quests only if they survive.
- NPCs act immediately after player PCs on same initiative.
- Dorrin did not know the 31-page Levitate detail unless told; corrected.
- Wagon was too heavy for Levitate.
- Draft horses too heavy for Levitate.

Current source status:

- Party has arrived at Goldenfields.
 - Giant attack has not begun.
 - Special NPCs have been handed out.
 - The party is about to enter Goldenfields and find Miros.
 - The Chapter 2 giant attack and leadership/tactics test is imminent, but not yet triggered.
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18. Emotional state of the party at Goldenfields arrival

Alphie

Excited, emotionally full, somewhat grounded after running/training/shower/quiet. Ready to get off the cloud. Carrying:

- Wren feelings,
- Dorrin's blessing,
- Kella's boundaries,
- Orven's grief,
- Zephyros's friendship,
- responsibility to Miros,
- looming Goldenfields danger.

Wren

Soft toward Alphie but focused. Cares for Rillix. Ready to tell Miros. Likely nervous about grief conversation.

Kella

Practical. Scanning gates/walls/roads. Less emotionally exposed now, more operational. Probably suspicious of Goldenfields' readiness.

Dorrin

Prepared. Spiritually alert. Ready for grief, priestly presence, and potential violence. Likely watching Goldenfields through the lens of his dream.

Zephyros

Fond farewell. Not accompanying the party further. Will possibly write later.

19. Best next move at the gate

The party needs to approach respectfully and clearly.

Possible Alphie approach:

Alphie reins the wagon in at a respectful distance from the gate, hands visible, posture calm.

“Good day. We’ve come from Nightstone by way of unusual transport. We’re looking for Miros Xelbrin of Northfurrow’s End. We carry family news for him, and something that belonged to his parents.”

That is clear, honourable, and does not blurt the death news to a gate guard.

If asked about the tower:

“A friend gave us passage. We are as surprised by that sentence as you are.”

If asked what they carry:

“Cider, letters, road gear, and a tressym named Rillix. Nothing hostile.”

If asked why they need Miros:

“The news is private. It should come to him directly and kindly.”

20. Best restart prompt

When resuming, say:

“We resume at Bookmark 8. The Tower of Zephyros has just dropped us outside Goldenfields and departed. Josh has handed out the Goldenfields special NPCs: Josh has Lifferlas, Ben has Miros, Talia has Oren, Naomi has Zi Liang. The party is on the road outside Goldenfields with the wagon, Rillix, cider, and the news for Miros. Marcus has asked how we approach the gate.”